

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cloud Security Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of hands-on experience delivering cloud security engineering, platform assurance, threat detection and incident response across large-scale Microsoft 365 and Azure environments. At the University of the Arts London I lead the design and operation of security controls across Microsoft 365 E5, Azure Active Directory (now Microsoft Entra ID), Microsoft Defender, Intune, and Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms, supporting an estate of approximately 8,000 users. I embed security guardrails and reference architectures into continuous integration and continuous delivery (CI/CD) pipelines, translate ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus and UK General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) requirements into technical controls and evidence, and drive continuous control improvement across cloud and endpoint surfaces. I am passionate about building security programmes that are practical, scalable and aligned to frameworks including National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) Cybersecurity Framework, Center for Internet Security (CIS) Controls and MITRE ATT&CK, and I am looking for a senior, technically hands-on remote role where I can broaden my cloud security engineering footprint further.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Cloud Security Engineering:** Microsoft 365 E5, Azure / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Azure Virtual Desktop, Microsoft Purview
- **Endpoint and Platform Security:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Office 365, Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) / Mobile Application Management (MAM), CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent (Endpoint Detection and Response)
- **Threat Detection and SIEM:** Microsoft Sentinel + Kusto Query Language (KQL), CrowdStrike NG-SIEM, CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, detection rule development, use-case lifecycle management
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle, MITRE ATT&CK framework, Cyber Kill Chain, forensic investigation, containment and remediation
- **DevSecOps and CI/CD Security:** Security guardrails in CI/CD pipelines, Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), PowerShell scripting and automation
- **Vulnerability and Compliance Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus; ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls
- **Governance and Frameworks:** ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, UK GDPR, NIST CSF, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA), CompTIA A+, Google IT Support Professional Certificate

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Lead cloud security engineering across Microsoft 365 E5, Azure, Microsoft Defender, Intune, Azure Virtual Desktop and Purview, establishing and maintaining security guardrails and reference architectures for an estate of approximately 8,000 users.
- Design and operate SIEM capabilities using Microsoft Sentinel with KQL and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM; author, tune and lifecycle detection logic to identify anomalous and malicious behaviours across cloud-native telemetry and endpoint data.
- Drive DevSecOps and CI/CD security by integrating security controls into deployment pipelines and automating policy enforcement through PowerShell and SOAR playbooks.

- Lead threat detection and incident response activities aligned to the NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle, serving as technical authority during declared incidents and producing post-incident reports with control improvement recommendations.
- Translate ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus and UK GDPR requirements into technical controls and audit-ready evidence; support annual certification activities and regulatory compliance reviews.
- Manage platform assurance across Conditional Access policies, MFA, SSO, Entra ID identity governance and PAM (BeyondTrust) to enforce least-privilege access at scale.
- Conduct continuous vulnerability management using Tenable.io, AppCheck and Pentra BAS, prioritising remediation through risk-based scoring aligned to CIS Controls and MITRE ATT&CK.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 – March 2025

- Administered and improved Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Microsoft Defender for Identity and Microsoft 365 Defender across the full UAL estate, reducing mean time to detect and respond to security events.
- Configured and maintained Conditional Access policies, MFA controls and SSO integrations across Azure Active Directory (Entra ID), aligning identity controls to Cyber Essentials Plus requirements.
- Deployed and managed CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight and Discover, configuring prevention policies, detection rules and automated response actions across endpoints.
- Operated Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, creating KQL detection rules and analytic workbooks; performed alert triage, incident investigation and threat hunting to identify attacker techniques mapped to MITRE ATT&CK.
- Managed Mimecast email security, Intune MDM/MAM and BeyondTrust PAM; wrote PowerShell scripts to automate routine administration and security control enforcement.
- Performed vulnerability scanning and remediation using Tenable.io and Nessus, producing management-level reports on risk posture and remediation progress.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 – March 2022

- Implemented and maintained security controls across cloud and on-premises infrastructure, including endpoint protection, patching and identity management aligned to ISO 27001.
- Configured and supported Microsoft Azure Active Directory, Intune and Microsoft 365 security settings, ensuring consistent policy enforcement across a SaaS product environment.
- Supported CI/CD pipeline security, contributing to secure deployment practices and access control across development and production environments.
- Delivered security awareness training, prepared vulnerability reports and contributed to audit and compliance activities supporting ISO 27001 certification.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity and Microsoft 365 Defender across an estate of approximately 8,000 users at UAL, achieving full endpoint visibility and reducing exposure to commodity threats.
- Built and operationalised Microsoft Sentinel SIEM with custom KQL detection rules and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM, significantly improving mean time to detect attacker techniques aligned to MITRE ATT&CK.
- Established BeyondTrust PAM across UAL, enforcing privileged access governance and eliminating standing administrative accounts in critical systems.
- Led Cyber Essentials Plus recertification and contributed to ISO 27001 compliance programmes, translating framework requirements into technical controls and auditable evidence.
- Automated routine security operations tasks using PowerShell and SOAR playbooks, reducing analyst toil and improving consistency of incident handling.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+

- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote (United Kingdom)